

Philipp Hilbert. *Product Owner who ships AI features, not just roadmaps.*

Positioning, B2B SaaS operator with ten years translating messy stakeholder requirements into working software – including AI integrations in Microsoft-adjacent enterprise environments.

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Dear Boardwise team,

I am applying for the Product Owner role for digital products and AI. I have spent the better part of ten years doing exactly what this role describes: standing between stakeholders who have real but inarticulate needs and engineering teams who need precise, prioritised work. The context has changed – defence AI platforms, public labour market analytics, InsurTech SaaS – but the mechanic is constant.

The part of this posting that caught my attention was not the AI integration work in isolation, but the combination of that with Vorstandsebene stakeholder management. At Emil Group I had to rebuild trust with C-level contacts at primary insurers and reinsurers after the product had missed commitments. I introduced structured weekly workshops, made every sprint increment demonstrably tangible, and reduced senior developer attrition from near-total to a single departure over the engagement. Boardwise's users – board secretariats, executive assistants, and Vorstandsmitglieder themselves – operate under similar pressure: low tolerance for ambiguity, high sensitivity to quality and reliability, and a genuine need for the product to reduce friction rather than create new kinds of it.

On the AI side: at Rohde & Schwarz, working within the FCAS programme, I delivered AI data management features end-to-end – user stories through implementation support through GitOps rollout – in a Microsoft-adjacent infrastructure environment with Kubernetes, ArgoCD, and OpenShift. I also reduced deployment times from several days to 20–40 minutes by introducing GitOps practices the team had been unable to implement before. Translating LLM-based features into backlog items that engineering can actually execute, with acceptance criteria that account for model behaviour edge cases, is something I do routinely with my own tooling and have done in production contexts.

At the Bundesagentur für Arbeit I served additionally as Deputy IT Security Officer, which means I understand the compliance and data lineage concerns that enterprise customers in

regulated sectors bring to conversations about AI features. That is not a checkbox – it directly shapes how I write acceptance criteria for anything that touches user data or decision audit trails.

Boardwise is working on a genuinely interesting problem. Strategic decision-making processes in large organisations are almost entirely analogue in practice, regardless of what software sits underneath them. The opportunity to make those processes faster, more traceable, and more defensible through well-designed software and carefully introduced AI is real, and the DAX customer base means the feedback loops are high-quality and high-stakes. I would like to be part of that.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*
